

# TRIPLE QUANTUM SCHUBERT CALCULUS

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ABSTRACT.

**Keywords:** Schubert polynomial, structure constant, Littlewood-Richardson rule, coproduct, double Schubert polynomial

**Mathematics classification codes:** 05E05, 05A05, 05A15, 14N10

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## 1. INTRODUCTION

## 2. DEFINITIONS AND STATEMENT OF RESULTS

### 2.1. Quantum double Schubert polynomials and triple quantum Schubert structure constants.

We fix  $n \geq 1$  and write

$$x = (x_1, \dots, x_n), \quad y = (y_1, \dots, y_n), \quad q = (q_1, \dots, q_{n-1}).$$

For  $1 \leq a < b \leq n$ , set

$$q_{ab} := q_a q_{a+1} \cdots q_{b-1},$$

and use the cohomological grading  $\deg q_i = 2$  (equivalently  $\deg q_{ab} = 2(b - a)$ ).

Let  $s_i$  act on the  $y$ -variables by swapping  $y_i, y_{i+1}$ , and define the divided difference operators

$$\partial_i^{(y)} f := \frac{f - s_i f}{y_i - y_{i+1}} \quad (1 \leq i \leq n-1).$$

For  $w \in S_n$ , if  $w = s_{i_1} \cdots s_{i_r}$  is any reduced word, set

$$\partial_w^{(y)} := \partial_{i_1}^{(y)} \cdots \partial_{i_r}^{(y)}.$$

Following Kirillov–Maeno [5], define the quantum elementary polynomials  $e_j^{(q)}(x_1, \dots, x_k)$  by

$$\Delta_k(t \mid x_1, \dots, x_k) := \sum_{j=0}^k t^{k-j} e_j^{(q)}(x_1, \dots, x_k),$$

where

$$\Delta_k(t \mid x_1, \dots, x_k) = \det \begin{pmatrix} x_1 + t & q_1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ -1 & x_2 + t & q_2 & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & -1 & x_3 + t & \ddots & 0 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \ddots & \ddots & q_{k-1} \\ 0 & \cdots & 0 & -1 & x_k + t \end{pmatrix}.$$

Let  $w_0 \in S_n$  be the longest permutation. The top quantum double Schubert polynomial is

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{w_0}(x; y) := \prod_{i=1}^{n-1} \Delta_i(-y_{n-i} \mid x_1, \dots, x_i),$$

and for  $w \in S_n$  we define

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x; y) := (-1)^{\ell(w_0) - \ell(w)} \partial_{w w_0}^{(y)} \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{w_0}(x; y).$$

Its specialization

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x) := \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x; 0)$$

is the quantum Schubert polynomial. In particular, at  $q = 0$  these recover the ordinary double and single Schubert polynomials.

Given their stability property, we may let the number of variables be infinite, indexing the polynomials by  $S_\infty$ . As a module over  $\mathbb{Z}[q][y]$ , the quantum double Schubert polynomials form a basis of  $\mathbb{Z}[q][x, y]$ , and we may write

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(x; z) = \sum_{w, d} q^d c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x; y)$$

where  $d = (d_1, \dots, d_{n-1})$  is a weak composition and  $q^d = q_1^{d_1} \cdots q_{n-1}^{d_{n-1}}$ . The coefficients  $c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z)$  are the *triple quantum Schubert structure constants*, which are polynomials in  $y$  and  $z$  with integer coefficients. This product respects the grading where for each  $i$ ,  $\deg y_i = \deg z_i = 1$  and  $\deg q_i = 2$ . In particular, if  $c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z) \neq 0$ , then  $\deg c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z) = \ell(u) + \ell(v) - \ell(w) + 2 \sum_i d_i$ . Unlike the usual triple Schubert structure constants, they do not exhibit triangularity in Bruhat order, and indeed we may have  $\ell(w) < \ell(u) + \ell(v)$ .

For  $d = (0, \dots, 0)$ , this is the ordinary triple Schubert calculus structure constant, and it was proved in [3] that these have the positivity property that they are polynomials in the differences  $y_i - z_j$  with nonnegative integer coefficients. We will refer to this as *triple Schubert positivity*. We have the following conjecture:

**Conjecture 2.1.** *For all  $u, v, w$  and  $d$ , the structure constants  $c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z)$  exhibit triple Schubert positivity.*

We will provide formulas below that demonstrate this in special cases. In particular, we prove

**Theorem 2.2.** *Suppose  $u, v, w \in S_\infty$  and  $v$  is  $k$ -Grassmannian for some  $k$ . Then for any  $d$ ,  $c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z)$  exhibits triple Schubert positivity.*

**2.2. The parabolic case.** Unlike ordinary cohomology or equivariant cohomology, quantum cohomology and equivariant quantum cohomology do not demonstrate simple functoriality, in the sense that a projection of the complete flag variety  $G/B$  to a partial flag variety  $G/P$  does not induce a homomorphism of rings  $QH_T^*(G/P) \rightarrow QH_T^*(G/B)$ , and indeed the quantum cohomology of  $G/P$  is not isomorphic to the subring of the quantum cohomology of  $G/B$  generated by the Schubert classes indexed by  $W^P$ . This is reflected in the fact that there are parabolic quantum double Schubert polynomials defined in a different manner that represent Schubert classes in  $QH_T^*(G/P)$  [6] and are not in general equal to the quantum double Schubert polynomials above.

**Definition 2.3** (Parabolic quantum double Schubert polynomials). Following Lam and Shimozono [6], we define parabolic quantum double Schubert polynomials as follows. Fix an integer  $n > 0$ . A parabolic subgroup  $W_P$  of  $S_n$ , which has Coxeter generators  $s_1, \dots, s_{n-1}$ , is generated by a subset  $P \subseteq \{s_1, \dots, s_{n-1}\}$ . In terms of the subgroup's properties, it is most natural to identify  $P$  by the reflections that it *excludes*. If  $P$  is generated by  $S \setminus \{s_{i_1}, \dots, s_{i_k}\}$  in increasing order, we define integers  $n_1, \dots, n_{k+1}$  with

$$n_1 + \cdots + n_{k+1} = n$$

by  $n_1 = i_1$  and  $n_p = i_p - i_{p-1}$  for  $2 \leq p \leq k+1$ . Then  $N_j$  for  $j \geq 1$  is defined by

$$N_j = n_1 + \cdots + n_j$$

for  $0 \leq j \leq k+1$ .

For such a setup, define a matrix  $D_j^P$  to be the  $n \times n$  matrix with  $x_1, \dots, x_n$  on the diagonal,  $-1$  on the superdiagonal, and  $(-1)^{n_{j+1}+1} q_j$  at  $(N_{j+1}, N_{j-1} + 1)$  for  $1 \leq j \leq k$ . Notice that there are precisely  $k$   $q$  variables, and we set

$$\deg q_j = n_j + n_{j+1}$$

Define

$$\Delta_j^P(t; x) = \det(D_j^P - t \text{Id})$$

Then we define the parabolic quantum double Schubert polynomials  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w^P(x; y)$  for  $w \in W^P$  by

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w^P(x; y) = (-1)^{\ell(w(w_0^P)^{-1})} \partial_{w(w_0^P)^{-1}}^{(y)} \prod_{j=1}^k \Delta_j^P(-y_{n-N_{j+1}+1}, \dots, -y_{n-N_j}; x)$$

where  $w_0^P$  is the longest element of  $W^P$ .

Taken as defined, when we vary  $n$  these polynomials are not stable under inclusion and do not form a basis of  $\mathbb{Z}[q][x_1, \dots, x_n; y]$  as a module over  $\mathbb{Z}[q][y]$ . To obtain stability and a basis, instead we fix  $n$  and choose  $N > n$  as large as we would like, maintaining  $N_{k+1} = n$  and setting  $n_{k+2} = N - n$ . From a cohomological perspective, this introduces “extraneous” polynomials that are indexed by elements not in  $W^P$ . The full indexing set is  $W^{P^+} \subset S_\infty$ , where

$$P^+ = P \cup \{s_{n+1}, s_{n+2}, \dots\}$$

**Example 2.4.** As equivariant cohomology rings of finite dimensional projective varieties over  $\mathbb{C}$  are finitely generated modules over the coefficient ring, it is fully expected that products of double Schubert polynomials may include terms indexed by permutations that do not lie within the indexing set of the basis of Schubert classes. For example, consider the following non-quantum double Schubert polynomial product, with  $P = \{s_1, s_2\}$  and basis elements in  $S_4$ :

$$\begin{aligned} \mathfrak{S}_{2413}(x; y) \mathfrak{S}_{3412}(x; y) = & -(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2)(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2 + \alpha_3)(\alpha_2 + \alpha_3) \mathfrak{S}_{3412}(x; y) \\ & + (\alpha_1 + \alpha_2)(\alpha_1 + 2\alpha_2 + 2\alpha_3 + \alpha_4) \mathfrak{S}_{35124}(x; y) \\ & - (\alpha_1 + \alpha_2) \mathfrak{S}_{361245}(x; y) \\ & - (\alpha_1 + 2\alpha_2 + 2\alpha_3 + \alpha_4) \mathfrak{S}_{45123}(x; y) \\ & + \mathfrak{S}_{461235}(x; y). \end{aligned}$$

Not only does the product  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{2413}^P(x; y) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{3412}^P(x; y)$  include extra terms indexed by permutations in  $W^P$ , there are also terms with nonzero coefficients that are in  $W^{P^+} \setminus W^P$ :

$$\begin{aligned} q_1(\alpha_1\alpha_2 + \alpha_1\alpha_3 + \alpha_2\alpha_3 + \alpha_2^2) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{132}^P(x; y) + q_1(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{231}^P(x; y) \\ + q_1(\alpha_2 + \alpha_3) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{1423}^P(x; y) \\ + q_1(\alpha_1 + \alpha_2) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{13254}^{P^+}(x; y) \\ + q_1 \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{14253}^{P^+}(x; y) \\ + q_1 \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{15234}^P(x; y) \\ + q_1 \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{2413}^P(x; y) \end{aligned}$$

**Definition 2.5** ( $q$ -vectors and Peterson-Woodward lifts). Define  $Q^\vee$ , for legacy purposes, to be the set of weak compositions. For an integer  $i$  and  $d \in Q^\vee$ , define

$$\langle d \rangle_i = 2d_i - d_{i-1} - d_{i+1}$$

The double indexed version will be denoted by

$$\langle d \rangle_{ij} = \sum_{k=i}^{j-1} \langle d \rangle_k$$

For a parabolic subgroup  $W_P$ , we define  $Q_P^\vee$  to be the set of weak compositions  $d$  such that  $\langle d \rangle_i = 0$  for all  $s_i \notin P$ . The  $q$ -vectors in  $W^P$  are indexed by  $Q^\vee / Q_P^\vee$ .

Let  $d_P \in Q^\vee / Q_P^\vee$ . A *Peterson-Woodward lift* of  $d_P$  is a  $d \in Q^\vee$  such that  $d_P \in d + Q_P^\vee$  and  $\langle d \rangle_{ij} \in \{0, -1\}$  for all  $i, j$  such that  $s_i, \dots, s_{j-1} \in P$ .

**Method 2.6** (Checking the Peterson-Woodward lift property). While backing out a Peterson-Woodward lift is difficult, going in the other direction is not. Suppose  $d \in Q^\vee$  and  $P$  is parabolic. If there is any  $i \in P$  such that  $\langle d \rangle_i \notin \{0, -1\}$ , then  $d$  is not a Peterson-Woodward lift. If this condition does hold, let  $z_P(d)$  be the set of all indexes  $i$  such that  $\langle d \rangle_i = 0$ . This set is naturally divided into maximal disjoint intervals  $I_1, \dots, I_m$ . We must check the additional condition that for each such  $I$  and each pair  $i < j$  with  $i, j-1 \in I$ , the condition  $\langle d \rangle_{ij} \in \{0, -1\}$  holds. If it does, then  $d$  is a Peterson-Woodward lift of a unique  $d_P \in Q^\vee / Q_P^\vee$ . We denote this  $d_P$  by  $\pi_P(d)$ . We prove the following result.

**Proposition 2.7.** *Let  $W_P$  be a parabolic subgroup of  $S_\infty$  with  $P = P^+$  and let  $u, v, w \in W^P$ . Then for any  $d_P = \pi_P(d) \in Q^\vee / Q_P^\vee$ , we have that*

$$c_{u,v}^{w,d_P}(y; z) = c_{u,v}^{w w_P w_{z_P(d)}, d}(y; z),$$

Thus, though we lack a simple functoriality property, we can reduce the computation of parabolic triple quantum Schubert structure constants completely to the complete flag variety case with an efficient algorithm. We obtain a nontrivial corollary from this.

**Corollary 2.8** (Triple quantum Schubert positivity for the Grassmannian case). *Suppose  $u, v, w \in S_n$  are  $k$ -Grassmannian, where  $P$  is the corresponding parabolic subgroup such that  $n_1 = k$  and  $n_2 = n - k$ . Then  $c_{u,v}^{w,d}(y; z)$  exhibits triple Schubert positivity.*

**Definition 2.9** ( $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$ ,  $\text{fix}_k(u, w)$ ,  $q_k(u, w)$ ,  $E_{p,k}(y; z)$ ,  $\mathbf{E}(y_A; z)$ ). We define a relation  $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  on pairs of permutations, introduced in its non-quantum form by Sottile [9], which was used originally to indicate when the coefficient of a Schubert polynomial is nonzero in a suitable application of the Pieri formula. In the generalization to double Schubert polynomials in [8], the same relation applies to all nonzero coefficients in the expansion of the generalized Pieri formula. The relation plays the same role in our case.

Given  $u, u' \in S_\infty$  and a positive integer  $k$ , we declare that  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  if there exists a  $p$  with  $0 \leq p \leq k$  such that there are transpositions  $t_{a_1 b_1}, \dots, t_{a_p b_p}$  satisfying

- (1)  $a_i \leq k < b_i$  for all  $i$
- (2)  $a_i \neq a_j$  whenever  $i \neq j$
- (3)  $b_i \geq b_j$  whenever  $i < j$
- (4) We have either

$$\ell(ut_{a_1 b_1} \cdots t_{a_i b_i}) = \ell(ut_{a_1 b_1} \cdots t_{a_{i-1} b_{i-1}}) + 1$$

or

$$\ell(ut_{a_1 b_1} \cdots t_{a_i b_i}) = \ell(ut_{a_1 b_1} \cdots t_{a_{i-1} b_{i-1}}) - 2(b_i - a_i) + 1$$

for all  $i$

- (5)  $w = ut_{a_1 b_1} \cdots t_{a_p b_p}$

In contrast to the non-quantum case,  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  does not imply that  $\ell(u) \leq \ell(w)$ , as the final condition can cause the length of the permutation to drop. For intuition, the condition  $\ell(ut_{ab}) = \ell(u) - 2(b - a) + 1$  means that if we write the reflection  $t_{ab}$  as

$$s_b s_{b-1} \cdots s_{a+1} s_a s_{a+1} \cdots s_{b-1} s_b$$

then each simple reflection in this word cancels a corresponding simple reflection in a reduced word for  $u$ , as opposite to the length-increase case where there is a word for which precisely one simple reflection is inserted, regardless of the length of the reflection as a permutation.

If  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , define

$$\text{fix}_k(u, w) = \{u(i) \mid i \leq k \text{ and } u(i) = w(i)\}$$

Also, we define  $q_k(u, w)$  recursively. If  $u = w$ , define  $q_k(u, w) = 1$ . If we have defined  $q_k(u, w')$  with  $w' = t_{a_1 b_1} \cdots t_{a_{p-1} b_{p-1}}$ , suppose  $\ell(w' t_{a_p b_p}) = \ell(w') + 1$ . Then define

$$q_k(u, w) = q_k(u, w')$$

If instead  $\ell(w' t_{a_p b_p}) = \ell(w') - 2(b_p - a_p) + 1$ , define

$$q_k(u, w) = q_k(u, w') q_{a_p b_p}$$

Suppose  $y$  and  $z$  are sets of variables and  $0 \leq p \leq k$  are integers. We define  $E_{p,k}(y; z)$  to be the factorial elementary symmetric polynomial in  $y$  and  $z$ . For specificity, this is the double Schubert polynomial  $\mathfrak{S}_{c[p,k]}(y; z)$  where

$$c[p, k] = s_{k-p+1} \cdots s_{k-1} s_k$$

If  $p = 0$ , the polynomial is identically 1. If  $p = k$ ,  $E_{k,k}(y; z)$  can be simply written as

$$E_{k,k}(y; z) = \prod_{i=1}^k (y_i - z_1)$$

An explicit formula can be written for general  $p$  without too much trouble as well, using e.g. [7]:

$$E_{p,k}(y; z) = \sum_{1 \leq i_1 < \dots < i_p \leq k} \prod_{j=1}^p (y_{i_j} - z_{i_j-j+1})$$

For a set  $A = \{i_1, \dots, i_{|A|}\}$ , we define

$$\mathbf{E}(y_A; z) = \prod_{i \in A} (y_i - z_1) = E_{|A|, |A|}(y_{i_1}, \dots, y_{i_{|A|}}; z),$$

the specialization of the factorial elementary polynomial to which the coefficients of the Pieri formula reduce. It will be used to express those coefficients.

*Remark 2.10* ( $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  and the quantum  $k$ -Bruhat order). The relation  $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  is built from the covers of the *quantum  $k$ -Bruhat order* introduced by Benedetti, Bergeron, Colmenarejo, Saliola, and Sottile [1] and studied further by Colmenarejo and Mayers [2]. That order  $\preceq_k^{\mathbf{q}}$  on  $S_\infty[\mathbf{q}]$  is generated by cover relations

$$u' \prec_k^{\mathbf{q}} \mathbf{q}^\gamma u' t_{ab}, \quad a \leq k < b,$$

each of exactly two kinds: a *classical* cover, with  $\gamma = 0$  and  $\ell(u' t_{ab}) = \ell(u') + 1$ , or a *quantum* cover, with  $\ell(u') + 1 = \ell(\mathbf{q}^\gamma u' t_{ab}) = \ell(u' t_{ab}) + 2(b - a)$ , that is  $\ell(u' t_{ab}) = \ell(u') - 2(b - a) + 1$  and  $\gamma = e_a + \dots + e_{b-1}$ . These are exactly the two alternatives of condition (4) of Definition 2.9. Consequently every sequence  $t_{a_1 b_1}, \dots, t_{a_p b_p}$  witnessing  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  is a saturated chain from  $u$  to  $\mathbf{q}^\alpha w$  in the quantum  $k$ -Bruhat order, where  $\mathbf{q}^\alpha$  is the monomial recorded by  $q_k(u, w)$ ; in particular  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  implies  $u \preceq_k^{\mathbf{q}} \mathbf{q}^\alpha w$ .

The relation  $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  is *not* the full order  $\preceq_k^{\mathbf{q}}$ , however. Definition 2.9 imposes the additional requirements that the lower indices  $a_1, \dots, a_p$  be pairwise distinct and the upper indices satisfy  $b_1 \geq \dots \geq b_p$ , so that  $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  admits only those saturated chains of a special form. Thus  $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  is strictly larger than the covering relation  $\prec_k^{\mathbf{q}}$  but strictly smaller than  $\preceq_k^{\mathbf{q}}$ : a general chain in the quantum  $k$ -Bruhat order may reuse a lower index  $a_i$ , and such chains do not contribute to the Pieri expansion. This is the quantum counterpart of the classical situation, where the Pieri relation of [9, 8] is likewise the restriction of the  $k$ -Bruhat order to chains with distinct lower indices, and it is exactly this restriction that makes the Pieri coefficients well defined.

What we use below is only that each individual step of a  $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  chain is a cover, and hence is governed by the following length-free description of the covers [1, Proposition 3.1] (see also [2, Proposition 4.2]): with  $i \leq k < j$ , the step  $u' \prec_k^{\mathbf{q}} \mathbf{q}^\gamma u' t_{ij}$  is a classical cover exactly when  $u'(i) < u'(j)$  and no  $l$  with  $i < l < j$  satisfies  $u'(i) < u'(l) < u'(j)$ , and it is a quantum cover exactly when  $u'(i) > u'(j)$  and every  $l$  with  $i < l < j$  satisfies  $u'(j) < u'(l) < u'(i)$ . We use this intrinsic characterization below in place of direct length computations.

**Theorem 2.11** (The Pieri formula). *Suppose  $u \in S_\infty$  and  $k \geq 1$ . Then*

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) \tilde{E}_{k,k}(x; z) = \sum_{u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w} q_k(u, w) \mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_k(u, w)}; z) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x; y)$$

### 3. EFFICIENT MULTIPLICATION OF (QUANTUM) DOUBLE SCHUBERT POLYNOMIALS

**Definition 3.1** ( $\mathbf{c}$ , (strict) dominant permutations,  $\theta$ ,  $\mu$ ,  $\tilde{\theta}$ ,  $\tilde{\mu}$ ). We say that a permutation  $\mu$  is *dominant* if  $\mathbf{c}_i(\mu) \geq \mathbf{c}_{i+1}(\mu)$  for all  $i$ . A permutation  $\mu$  is said to be *strict dominant* if  $\mu$  is dominant and whenever  $\mathbf{c}_i(\mu) \neq 0$  we have  $\mathbf{c}_i(\mu) > \mathbf{c}_{i+1}(\mu)$ . For a permutation  $v \in S_\infty$ , we define a dominant permutation  $\mu(v)$  recursively as follows. If  $v$  is already dominant, define  $\mu(v) = v$ . Otherwise, let  $i$  be the maximal index such that  $\mathbf{c}_i(v) < \mathbf{c}_{i+1}(v)$ , and define

$$\mu(v) = \mu(v s_i)$$

Define  $\theta_i(v)$  to be  $\mathbf{c}_i(\mu(v))$ .

Similarly, for a permutation  $v \in S_\infty$ , we define a strict dominant permutation  $\tilde{\mu}(v)$  recursively as follows. If  $v$  is already strict dominant, define  $\tilde{\mu}(v) = v$ . Otherwise, let  $i$  be the maximal index such that  $\mathbf{c}_{i+1}(v) \neq 0$  and  $\mathbf{c}_i(v) \leq \mathbf{c}_{i+1}(v)$ , then define

$$\tilde{\mu}(v) = \tilde{\mu}(v s_i)$$

Define  $\tilde{\theta}_i(v)$  to be  $\mathbf{c}_i(\tilde{\mu}(v))$ .

**Definition 3.2** ( $\stackrel{i}{\Rightarrow}$ ,  $\sigma_i(u, v)$ ,  $D_i(u, v)$ ). Let  $u, v \in S_\infty$  and  $i \geq 1$  be an integer. We define  $u \stackrel{i}{\Rightarrow} v$  if there exist distinct integers  $b_1, b_2, \dots, b_k$  such that  $b_j \neq i$  for all  $j$ ,  $\ell(ut_{i,b_1} \cdots t_{i,b_k}) = \ell(u) + k$  for all  $k$ , and

$$v = ut_{i,b_1} \cdots t_{i,b_k}$$

We define

$$\sigma_i(u, v) = \#\{j \mid b_j < i\}$$

and we define

$$D_i(u, v) = \{u(i)\} \cup \{u(j) \mid u(j) \neq v(j)\}$$

**Theorem 3.3** (Formula for ordinary double Schubert polynomials). *Suppose  $v \in S_\infty$ . Then*

$$\mathfrak{S}_v(x; z) = \sum_{(v_0, \dots, v_k)} \prod_{i=1}^k (-1)^{\sigma_i(v_{i-1}, v_i)} E_{\theta_i(v) - \ell(v_{i-1}, v_i), \theta_i(v)}(x; z_{D_i(v_{i-1}, v_i)})$$

Where  $v_{i-1} \stackrel{i}{\Rightarrow} v_i$  for all  $i$ ,  $v_0 = 1$ , and  $v_k = v\mu(v^{-1})$ .

**Theorem 3.4** (Formula for quantum double Schubert polynomials). *Suppose  $v \in S_\infty$ . Then*

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(x; z) = \sum_{(v_0, \dots, v_k)} \prod_{i=1}^k (-1)^{\sigma_i(v_{i-1}, v_i)} E_{\theta_i(v) - \ell(v_{i-1}, v_i), \tilde{\theta}_i(v)}^q(x; z_{D_i(v_{i-1}, v_i)})$$

Where  $v_{i-1} \stackrel{i}{\Rightarrow} v_i$  for all  $i$ ,  $v_0 = 1$ , and  $v_k = v\tilde{\mu}(v^{-1})$ .

Coupled with the Pieri formulas, these formulas give a relatively efficient method for computing products of (quantum) double Schubert polynomials.

**Definition 3.5** ( $\chi_{j;n}$ ,  $\chi^{(n)}$ ). Recall the definition of the commuting difference operators  $\chi_{j;n}$ , with  $j \leq n$ , defined by Fomin, Gelfand, and Postnikov, as follows:

$$\chi_{j,n} = x_j - \sum_{1 \leq i < j} q_{ij} \partial^{t_{ij}} + \sum_{j < k \leq n} q_{jk} \partial^{t_{jk}}$$

We denote the sequence  $(\chi_{1;n}, \dots, \chi_{n;n})$  with  $n$  fixed by  $\chi^{(n)}$ . Recall (CITATION) that if  $\mathfrak{S}_v(x)$  has at most  $n$  variables, then

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)})(1) = \mathfrak{S}_v(x)$$

and hence

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)}; z)(1) = \mathfrak{S}_v(x; z)$$

We specify a more precise formula, as follows.

**Theorem 3.6.** *Suppose  $v \in S_n$ . Then*

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)}; z) = \sum_{u \in S_n, d} q^d c_{u,v}^{1,d}(x; z) \partial^u$$

*Proof.* Note that if  $\mathfrak{S}_u(x)$  has at most  $n$  variables, then

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(\chi^{(n)}; y) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)}; z) = \sum_{w, d} q^d c_{u,v}^{w,d}(y; z) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(\chi^{(n)}; y)$$

We thus have that

$$(\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(\chi^{(n)}; y) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)}; z))(1) = \sum_{w, d} q^d c_{u,v}^{w,d}(y; z) \mathfrak{S}_w(x; y)$$

This is also equal to

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)}; z)(\mathfrak{S}_u(x; y))$$

due to the fact that  $(\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(\chi^{(n)}; y))(1) = \mathfrak{S}_u(x; y)$ . To obtain the coefficient of  $\partial^u$  in  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)}; z)$ , we set  $y = x$  after applying this operator. Since  $\mathfrak{S}_w(x; x) = 0$  unless  $w = 1$ , we have that

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v(\chi^{(n)}; z)(\mathfrak{S}_u(x; y))|_{y=x} = \sum_d q^d c_{u,v}^{1,d}(x; z)$$

and the result follows.  $\square$

**Theorem 3.7.** *Let  $k$  be an integer and let  $v, w \in S_\infty$ . Then*

$$\sum_d q^d c_{s_k, v}^{w, d}(y; z) = c_{s_k, v}^w(y; z) + \sum_{i \leq k < j} q_{ij} \mathfrak{S}_{vt_{ij}w^{-1}}(y; z)$$

*Proof.* We have that the desired value is equal to the coefficient of  $\mathfrak{S}_w(x; y)$  in

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{s_k}(\chi^{(n)}; y)(\mathfrak{S}_v(x; z))$$

We have that

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{s_k}(\chi^{(n)}; y) = \mathfrak{S}_{s_k}(x; y) + \sum_{i \leq k < j \leq n} q_{ij} \partial^{t_{ij}}$$

Applying this operator, we obtain

$$\sum_{i \leq k < j \leq n} q_{ij} \mathfrak{S}_{vt_{ij}}(x; z) + \sum_w c_{s_k, v}^w(y; z) \mathfrak{S}_w(x; y)$$

Applying the Cauchy formula, this is equal to

$$\sum_{i \leq k < j, u} q_{ij} \mathfrak{S}_{vt_{ij}u^{-1}}(y; z) \mathfrak{S}_u(x; y) + \sum_w c_{s_k, v}^w(y; z) \mathfrak{S}_w(x; y)$$

Setting  $u = w$  and allowing  $n$  to be sufficiently large, we obtain the result.  $\square$

#### 4. QUANTUM TO CLASSICAL REDUCTION FOR GRASSMANNIAN PRODUCTS

**Theorem 4.1** ([4, Theorem 2.7]). *We have the following.*

- (1)  $c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; y) = 0$  unless  $\text{sgn}_i(w) + \langle d \rangle_i \leq \text{sgn}_i(u) + \text{sgn}_i(v)$  for all  $i$ .
- (2) If  $\text{sgn}_k(w) + \langle d \rangle_k = \text{sgn}_k(u) + \text{sgn}_k(v) = 2$  for some  $k$ , then

$$c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; y) = c_{us_k, vs_k}^{ws_k, d - \delta_k}(y; y) = \begin{cases} c_{us_k, v}^{ws_k, d - \delta_k}(y; y) & \text{if } \text{sgn}_k(w) = 0 \\ c_{us_k, v}^{ws_k, d}(y; y) & \text{if } \text{sgn}_k(w) = 1 \end{cases}$$

*This is symmetric in  $u$  and  $v$ .*

**Corollary 4.2** ([4, Corollary 2.8]). *Let  $u, v, w \in S_\infty$  and  $d \in Q^\vee$ . Fix an index  $i$ .*

- (1) If  $\langle d \rangle_i = \text{sgn}_i(u) = 0$  and  $\text{sgn}_i(w) = \text{sgn}_i(v) = 1$ , then

$$c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; y) = c_{u, vs_i}^{ws_i, d}(y; y).$$

- (2) If  $\langle d \rangle_i = \text{sgn}_i(u) = 1$  and  $\text{sgn}_i(w) = \text{sgn}_i(v) = 0$ , then

$$c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; y) = c_{us_i, v}^{ws_i, d - \delta_i}(y; y).$$

*This is symmetric in  $u$  and  $v$ .*

**Lemma 4.3.** *We have that*

$$c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z) = \sum_{v_1 \cdot v_2 = v} c_{u, v_2}^{w, d}(y; y) \mathfrak{S}_{v_1}(y; z)$$

**Theorem 4.4** (Quantum reduction holds for triple quantum Schubert coefficients). *We have the following.*

- (1)  $c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z) = 0$  unless  $\text{sgn}_i(w) + \langle d \rangle_i \leq \text{sgn}_i(u) + \text{sgn}_i(v)$  for all  $i$ .
- (2) If  $\text{sgn}_k(w) + \langle d \rangle_k = \text{sgn}_k(u) + \text{sgn}_k(v) = 2$  for some  $k$ , then

$$c_{u, v}^{w, d}(y; z) = c_{us_k, vs_k}^{ws_k, d - \delta_k}(y; z) = \begin{cases} c_{us_k, v}^{ws_k, d - \delta_k}(y; z) & \text{if } \text{sgn}_k(w) = 0 \\ c_{us_k, v}^{ws_k, d}(y; z) & \text{if } \text{sgn}_k(w) = 1 \end{cases}$$

*This is symmetric in  $u$  and  $v$ .*

*Proof.* For (1), we note that since  $\text{sgn}_i(v_2) \leq \text{sgn}_i(v)$  for any factorization  $v_1 \cdot v_2 = v$ , we have that  $\text{sgn}_i(w) + \langle d \rangle_i \leq \text{sgn}_i(u) + \text{sgn}_i(v_2)$  is a necessary condition for  $c_{u, v_2}^{w, d}(y; y) \neq 0$ . The result then follows from Lemma 4.3.

For (2), we note that if  $\text{sgn}_k(w) + \langle d \rangle_k = \text{sgn}_k(u) + \text{sgn}_k(v) = 2$ , then since  $\text{sgn}_k(v_2) = \text{sgn}_k(v)$  for any factorization  $v_1 \cdot v_2 = v$  such that  $c_{u, v_2}^{w, d}(y; y) \neq 0$ , Theorem 4.1(2) holds for each term in the sum in Lemma 4.3, and the result follows.  $\square$

**Corollary 4.5** ( $z$ -version of Corollary 4.2(2)). *Let  $u, v, w \in S_\infty$  and  $d \in Q^\vee$ , and fix an index  $i$  with  $\text{sgn}_i(v) = 0$ . If  $\langle d \rangle_i = \text{sgn}_i(u) = 1$  and  $\text{sgn}_i(w) = 0$ , then*

$$c_{u,v}^{w,d}(y; z) = c_{us_i, v}^{ws_i, d - \delta_i}(y; z).$$

*Proof.* Since  $\text{sgn}_i(v_2) \leq \text{sgn}_i(v) = 0$  for every factorization  $v_1 \cdot v_2 = v$ , the hypotheses of Corollary 4.2(2) hold for each term  $c_{u, v_2}^{w, d}(y; y)$  appearing in Lemma 4.3, so  $c_{u, v_2}^{w, d}(y; y) = c_{us_i, v_2}^{ws_i, d - \delta_i}(y; y)$ . Resumming via Lemma 4.3 gives the claim.  $\square$

**Lemma 4.6** (Reduction to a coroot supported at  $k$ ). *Let  $u, v, w \in S_\infty$  and let  $d \in Q^\vee$ . Suppose  $v$  has precisely one descent, which is  $k$ . If  $c_{u,v}^{w,d}(y; z) \neq 0$ , then there exist  $u', w' \in S_\infty$  and  $d' \in Q^\vee$  with  $0 \leq d' \leq d$  such that*

$$c_{u,v}^{w,d}(y; z) = c_{u',v}^{w',d'}(y; z)$$

*and  $\langle d' \rangle_i \leq 0$  for all  $i \neq k$ . Moreover, if  $d' \neq 0$  then  $\langle d' \rangle_k > 0$ .*

*Proof.* Suppose  $\langle d \rangle_i > 0$  for some  $i \neq k$ , and choose such an  $i$  to be maximal. Because  $v$  is  $k$ -Grassmannian,  $\text{sgn}_i(v) = 0$ , so Theorem 4.4(1) forces

$$\text{sgn}_i(w) + \langle d \rangle_i \leq \text{sgn}_i(u) + \text{sgn}_i(v) = \text{sgn}_i(u) \leq 1.$$

Since  $\langle d \rangle_i \geq 1$ , we conclude  $\langle d \rangle_i = 1$ ,  $\text{sgn}_i(u) = 1$ , and  $\text{sgn}_i(w) = 0$ . These are exactly the hypotheses of Corollary 4.5 (note  $\text{sgn}_i(v) = 0$ ), so

$$c_{u,v}^{w,d}(y; z) = c_{us_i, v}^{ws_i, d - \delta_i}(y; z).$$

Moreover  $\langle d \rangle_i = 2d_i - d_{i-1} - d_{i+1} = 1$  with  $d_{i\pm 1} \geq 0$  forces  $d_i \geq 1$ , so  $d - \delta_i \in Q^\vee$  with  $0 \leq d - \delta_i \leq d$  and  $|d - \delta_i| < |d|$ . Replacing  $(u, w, d)$  by  $(us_i, v \text{ fixed}, ws_i, d - \delta_i)$  and iterating, the quantity  $|d|$  strictly decreases at each step, so the process terminates in a triple  $(u', w', d')$  with  $\langle d' \rangle_i \leq 0$  for all  $i \neq k$ .

Finally, for any finitely supported  $d' \in Q^\vee$  the values  $\langle d' \rangle_i = 2d'_i - d'_{i-1} - d'_{i+1}$  telescope to  $\sum_i \langle d' \rangle_i = 0$ . Hence  $\langle d' \rangle_k = -\sum_{i \neq k} \langle d' \rangle_i \geq 0$ , with equality if and only if  $\langle d' \rangle_i = 0$  for all  $i$ , i.e.  $d' = 0$ . Thus  $d' \neq 0$  implies  $\langle d' \rangle_k > 0$ .  $\square$

## 5. PROOF OF THE PIERI FORMULA

**Lemma 5.1.** *Let  $u \in S_\infty$  and let  $i, j \geq 1$ . Then*

$$\begin{aligned} (x_i - z_j) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) &= (y_{u(i)} - z_j) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) + \sum_{\substack{p \neq i \\ \ell(ut_{ip}) = \ell(u) + 1}} \text{sign}(p - i) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{ut_{ip}}(x; y) \\ &+ \sum_{\substack{p \neq i \\ \ell(ut_{ip}) = \ell(u) - 2|p - i| + 1}} \text{sign}(p - i) q_{ip} \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{ut_{ip}}(x; y) \end{aligned}$$

**Definition 5.2** (Descents of a cycle,  $\text{desc}_u(c)$ ). Let  $c$  be a cycle and suppose  $u \in S_\infty$ . Write  $c$  as

$$(a_1, \dots, a_n)$$

where  $a_n > a_i$  for all  $i < n$  (this is a unique way to express the cycle since the  $a_j$  are distinct). Then for any  $i$  with  $1 \leq i < n$  we say that  $a_i$  is a *descent* of  $c$  with respect to  $u$  if  $u(a_i) > u(a_{i+1})$ . We denote the set of all descents of  $c$  with respect to  $u$  by  $\text{desc}_u(c)$ .

**Lemma 5.3.** *Suppose  $u, w \in S_\infty$  and let  $k > 0$  be an integer. Then  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  if and only if there exist pairwise disjoint cyclic permutations  $c_1, \dots, c_n$  of respective cycle lengths  $p_1 + 1, \dots, p_n + 1$  such that*

$$w = uc_1 \cdots c_n$$

*where for each  $i$  there exist pairwise distinct positive integers  $a_{i,1}, \dots, a_{i,p_i}$  and  $b_i$  such that we may write the cycle  $c_i$  as*

$$c_i = (a_{i,p_i}, a_{i,p_i-1}, \dots, a_{i,1}, b_i)$$

*with  $a_{i,j} \leq k$  for all  $1 \leq j \leq p_i$ ,  $b_i > k$ , and  $b_i > b_j$  if  $i < j$ , and such that for each  $m$  we have*

$$\ell(u, uc_1 \cdots c_m) = \sum_{i=1}^m \left( p_i - 2 \sum_{a \in \text{desc}_u(c_i)} (b_i - a) \right)$$



and

$$\ell(u, w) + \deg q_k(u, w) = p_1 + \cdots + p_n$$

*Proof.* Suppose first that  $u \xrightarrow{k} w$ . By Remark 2.10 there are transpositions  $t_{a_1 b_1}, \dots, t_{a_p b_p}$  with  $a_i \leq k < b_i$ , the  $a_i$  pairwise distinct, and  $b_1 \geq \cdots \geq b_p$ , such that

$$u = u_0 \leq_k^{\mathbf{q}} u_1 \leq_k^{\mathbf{q}} \cdots \leq_k^{\mathbf{q}} u_p = w, \quad u_i = u_{i-1} t_{a_i b_i},$$

is a saturated chain in the quantum  $k$ -Bruhat order. Grouping the transpositions that share a common top  $b$  assembles them, exactly as in the non-quantum case [8, Lemma 7.3], into a cycle

$$c = (a_{i+r}, \dots, a_i, b) = t_{a_i b} \cdots t_{a_{i+r} b};$$

ranging over the distinct values of  $b$  in decreasing order yields pairwise disjoint cycles  $c_1, \dots, c_n$  with  $w = u c_1 \cdots c_n$  of the asserted form. To compute the length, set  $c^{(j)} = t_{a_i b} \cdots t_{a_j b} = (a_j, \dots, a_i, b)$ ; the step from  $u c^{(j-1)}$  to  $u c^{(j)} = u c^{(j-1)} t_{a_j b}$  exchanges the value  $u(a_{j-1})$  in position  $b$  with the value  $u(a_j)$  in position  $a_j$ . By the cover characterization of Remark 2.10 this step is a classical cover, of length increment  $+1$ , when  $u(a_j) < u(a_{j-1})$ , and a quantum cover, of length increment  $-(2(b - a_j) - 1)$ , when  $u(a_j) > u(a_{j-1})$ , that is, precisely when  $a_j \in \text{desc}_u(c)$ . Summing these increments over the steps constituting  $c_1, \dots, c_n$  gives

$$\ell(u, u c_1 \cdots c_n) = \sum_{i=1}^m \left( p_i - 2 \sum_{a \in \text{desc}_u(c_i)} (b_i - a) \right),$$

and, recording each quantum step in the  $q$ -degree as in Definition 2.9,  $\ell(u, w) + \deg q_k(u, w) = p_1 + \cdots + p_n$ .

Conversely, suppose pairwise disjoint cycles  $c_1, \dots, c_n$  as in the statement are given, and write  $c_i = t_{a_{i,1} b_i} \cdots t_{a_{i,p_i} b_i}$ . Applying these transpositions in order, the step from  $u c^{(j-1)}$  to  $u c^{(j)} = u c^{(j-1)} t_{a_{i,j} b_i}$  exchanges the values  $u(a_{i,j})$  and  $u(a_{i,j-1})$  in positions  $a_{i,j} \leq k < b_i$ . Any transposition  $t_{ab}$  changes the length by at least  $+1$  when it places the larger of the two exchanged values in the smaller position  $a$ , and by at least  $-(2(b - a) - 1)$  in every case, with equality in either bound if and only if the step is a classical, respectively quantum, cover in the sense of Remark 2.10. Applying the first bound at the non-descent steps and the second at the descents therefore gives

$$\ell(u, u c_1 \cdots c_n) \geq p_1 + \cdots + p_n - 2 \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{a \in \text{desc}_u(c_i)} (b_i - a),$$

and the length hypothesis of the statement forces equality throughout, so every step is a cover of the quantum  $k$ -Bruhat order and hence  $u \xrightarrow{k} w$ .  $\square$

**Definition 5.4** ( $\triangleleft$ ). If  $u, u' \in S_\infty$ , we define  $u \triangleleft u'$  if  $\ell(u, u') = 1$  or  $u' = u t_{ab}$  where  $\ell(u, u') = 1 - 2(b - a)$ . Equivalently,  $u \triangleleft u t_{ab}$  exactly when  $u \leq_k^{\mathbf{q}} u t_{ab}$  is a cover of the quantum  $k$ -Bruhat order for some (equivalently, any)  $k$  with  $a \leq k < b$ , in the sense of Remark 2.10.

**Lemma 5.5.** Suppose  $u, w \in S_\infty$  and let  $k > 1$  be an integer. Suppose  $u \xrightarrow{k} w$  and let  $c = (a_p, \dots, a_1, b)$  be a cycle as in Lemma 5.3 in the decomposition of  $u^{-1}w$ . Then  $\text{desc}_u(c)$  has at most one element.

*Proof.* This is clearly true if  $p = 1$ , or if the result holds for  $p - 1$  but  $c^{(p-1)}$  has no descents. Suppose then that  $c^{(p-1)}$  has a descent, say  $a_i$  for exactly one  $i < p$  by the induction hypothesis, and that  $u(a_p) > u(a_{p-1})$ , meaning that  $a_p \in \text{desc}_u(c^{(p-1)})$ .  $a_i$  being a descent would require that

$$u(a_i) > u c^{(i-1)}(j) > u(a_{i-1})$$

for all  $j$  with  $a_i < j < b$ . Furthermore, we also have that for all  $j$  with  $a_p < j < b$  that

$$u(a_p) > u c^{(p-1)}(j) > u(a_{p-1})$$

Suppose  $a_p < a_i$ . Then  $u(a_p) > u c^{(p-1)}(a_i) = u(a_{i-1}) > u(a_{p-1})$ . This means that necessarily  $a_{p-1} < a_i$ , since  $u(a_{i-1}) = u c^{(i)}(a_i)$  is minimal in the range  $a_i \leq j \leq b$  in  $u c^{(i)}$ . For the same reason, we cannot have that  $u c^{(p-2)}(b) < u(a_{i-1})$ , because this would have to come from some  $t_{a_q b}$  with  $i < q < p - 1$ ,  $a_q < a_i$ , and  $u(a_q) < u(a_{i-1})$ , which would increase the length by more than 1. However, since  $u c^{(p-2)}(b) > u(a_{i-1}) > u(a_{p-1})$ , this would imply that  $t_{a_{p-1} b}$  increases the length by more than 1, which is a contradiction. Thus we cannot have a descent  $a_p$  with  $a_p < a_i$ .

If instead  $a_p > a_i$ , then  $u(a_i) > u(a_p) > u(a_{i-1})$ . Since  $a_p$  is a descent,  $uc^{(p-1)}(b) = u(a_{p-1}) < u(a_p)$ , but  $uc^{(i)}(b) = u(a_i) > u(a_p)$ . This would imply that there is some  $q$  with  $i < q \leq p-1$  such that  $a_q > a_p$  and  $uc^{(q-1)}t_{a_q b}(b) = u(a_q) < u(a_p)$ , because if we had  $a_q < a_p$  then the length would increase by more than 1. Let  $q$  be minimal with this property. In that case,  $u(a_{q-1}) > u(a_p)$  and  $uc^{(p-1)}(a_q) = u(a_{q-1})$ , contradicting the fact that  $a_p$  is a descent.

Having excluded the cases  $a_p > a_i$  and  $a_p < a_i$ , by the assumption that  $a_p \neq a_i$  it follows by induction that there can be at most one descent.  $\square$

**Definition 5.6** (Redefinition of  $\text{desc}_u(c)$ ). If  $c$  is a cycle, we redefine  $\text{desc}_u(c)$  to be the unique element of the previously defined set  $\text{desc}_u(c)$  if it exists, or otherwise 0.

**Lemma 5.7.** Suppose  $u, w \in S_\infty$  and let  $k > 1$  be an integer. Suppose  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  and let  $c = (a_p, \dots, a_1, b)$  be a cycle as in Lemma 5.3 in the decomposition of  $u^{-1}w$ , with  $a_q = k$  being a descent. Then for all  $j \geq q$  we have that  $u(a_j) > u(b)$ .

*Proof.* We have that  $u(a_q) > u(a_{q-1})$ . By Lemma 5.5,  $k$  is the only descent of  $c$ . We claim that for all  $r$  with  $k \leq r < b$  we have that  $u(r) > u(b)$ . This is because for all such  $r$  we have that  $u(a_{q-1}) < u(r)$  since  $a_q$  is a descent, and if  $u(b) > u(r)$  for some such  $r$  then we may pick a maximal  $\ell < q$  such that  $u(a_\ell) > u(r)$  for some such  $r$ . Then  $u(a_{\ell+1}) < u(r)$  for all such  $r$ , and the reflection  $t_{a_{\ell+1}b}$  would increase the length by more than 1, which cannot happen. For the same reason, we cannot have that  $u(a_m) < u(r)$  for any  $r$  with  $k < r \leq b$ , since  $u(a_q) > u(r)$  for all such  $r$  and hence the reflection  $t_{a_{m-1}a_m}$  would increase the length by more than  $q$ . Thus since in particular  $u(r) > u(b)$  for all such  $r$ , we must have that  $u(a_j) > u(b)$  for all  $j \geq q$ , as desired.  $\square$

**Lemma 5.8.** Suppose  $u, w \in S_\infty$  and let  $k > 1$  be an integer. If  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  but  $u \not\overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , then there is a unique  $b > k$  such that  $wt_{kb} \triangleleft w$  and  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} wt_{kb}$ . Furthermore, in that case there does not exist a  $a < k$  such that  $wt_{ak} \triangleleft w$  and  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} wt_{ak}$ .

*Proof.* Suppose  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  but  $u \not\overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ . Let  $c_1, \dots, c_n$  be the pairwise disjoint cycles in the decomposition of  $u^{-1}w$ , with the cycle length of  $c_i$  being  $p_i + 1$ . Some such cycle must contain  $k$ , as otherwise we would have  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  by Lemma 5.3. Assume that  $c_i = (a_{i,p_1}, \dots, a_{i,1}, b_i)$  is the cycle that contains  $k$  and set  $b = b_i$ . We claim that  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} wt_{kb}$  and  $wt_{kb} \triangleleft w$ . Note that  $w = (wt_{kb})t_{kb}$  and hence

$$(uc_1 \cdots c_n t_{kb})t_{kb} = w$$

Let  $j$  be the index such that  $a_j = k$ . Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} (a_{i,p_i}, \dots, a_{i,j+1}, k, a_{i,j-1}, \dots, a_{i,1}, b_i)t_{kb} &= (a_{i,j-1}, \dots, a_{i,1}, b, a_{i,p_i}, \dots, a_{i,j+1}, k)t_{kb} \\ &= (a_{i,j-1}, \dots, a_{i,1}, b)(a_{i,p_i}, \dots, a_{i,j+1}, k) \end{aligned}$$

Note that  $wt_{kb}(k) = w(b) = u(a_{i,p_i})$  and  $wt_{kb}(b) = w(k) = u(a_{i,j-1})$ . We need that

$$\ell(u, wt_{kb}) = p'_i + p''_i - 2(b - \text{desc}_u(c'_i)) - 2(k - \text{desc}_u(c''_i)) + \ell(u, uc_1 \cdots c_{i-1}c_{i+1} \cdots c_m)$$

We have that

$$\ell(u, w) = p_i - 2(b - \text{desc}_u(c_i)) + \ell(u, uc_1 \cdots c_{i-1}c_{i+1} \cdots c_m)$$

and

$$\ell(u, wt_{kb}) \geq p'_i + p''_i - 2(b - \text{desc}_u(c'_i)) - 2(k - \text{desc}_u(c''_i)) + \ell(u, uc_1 \cdots c_{i-1}c_{i+1} \cdots c_m)$$

If  $c'_i$  has a descent, then  $c''_i$  does not, and we are done. If  $c''_i$  has a descent, then

$$w(k) = u(a_{i,j-1}) < u(b) < u(a_{i,p_i}) = w(b)$$

by Lemma 5.7, so

$$\ell(w) < \ell(wt_{bk}) \leq \ell(w) + 2(b - k) - 1$$

so

$$\ell(u, wt_{kb}) = \ell(wt_{bk}) - \ell(u) \leq p'_i + p''_i - 2(b - \text{desc}_u(c'_i)) - 2(b - \text{desc}_u(c''_i)) + 2(b - k) + \ell(u, uc_1 \cdots c_{i-1}c_{i+1} \cdots c_m)$$

Since we already have the opposite inequality, we are done if  $c''_i$  has a descent, since  $wt_{bk} \triangleleft w$ . If neither has a descent but  $c_i$  does, then this descent must be at  $k$ . We have that  $wt_{bk}(k) = u(a_{i,p_i}) > u(b)$  by Lemma

5.7, and  $wt_{bk}(b) = u(a_{i,j-1}) < u(b)$ . Furthermore,  $u(k) > u(b) > u(r) > u(a_{i,j-1})$  for all  $r$  with  $k < r < b$  since  $k$  is a descent. Thus  $wt_{bk} \triangleleft w$ .

$a_{i,q} < r < b$ , so the length decreases by  $2(b - a_{i,q}) - 1$  as desired. If  $u(a_{i,j+1}) > u(k)$

The uniqueness of  $b$  among the indices  $r > k$  with  $\ell(ut_{kr}) = \ell(u) + 1$ , and the nonexistence of an index  $q < k$  with  $\ell(ut_{qk}) = \ell(u) + 1$  and  $ut_{qk} \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , now follow exactly as in the proof of [8, Lemma 7.6]. Those arguments use only the disjoint cycle characterization of the Pieri relation, which in the present setting is supplied by Lemma 5.3 in place of [8, Lemma 7.3]: in each case the reflection  $t_{kr}$  (respectively  $t_{qk}$ ) either merges the cycle  $c_i$  containing  $k$  with another cycle or splits it so that  $k$  and a second index exceeding  $k - 1$  lie in a common cycle of  $(ut_{kr})^{-1}w$  (respectively  $(ut_{qk})^{-1}w$ ), whence  $ut_{kr} \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  (respectively  $ut_{qk} \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ ) by Lemma 5.3.  $\square$

We organize the inductive step of Theorem 2.11 around the position  $k$ , distinguishing whether or not  $u(k) = w(k)$ . The following lemma records the two combinatorial facts about the interaction of  $\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow}$  and  $\overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow}$  at position  $k$  that make this dichotomy exhaustive.

**Lemma 5.9.** *Suppose  $u, w \in S_\infty$  and let  $k > 1$  be an integer.*

- (i) *If  $u(k) = w(k)$ , then  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  if and only if  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ .*
- (ii) *If  $u(k) \neq w(k)$  and  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , then  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ .*

*Proof.* Both statements follow from the cycle description of Lemma 5.3, according to which  $u \overset{m}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  if and only if in the disjoint cycle decomposition of  $u^{-1}w$  each cycle contains exactly one index exceeding  $m$ , subject to the length conditions. If  $u(k) = w(k)$  then  $k$  is a fixed point of  $u^{-1}w$ , hence lies in no nontrivial cycle; the constraint distinguishing level  $k$  from level  $k - 1$  concerns only the indices exceeding  $k - 1$  that occur in the cycles, and  $k$  is not among them. Thus the cycle conditions for level  $k$  and level  $k - 1$  coincide, proving (i). For (ii), if  $u(k) \neq w(k)$  then  $k$  lies in a nontrivial cycle  $c$  of  $u^{-1}w$ ; if  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , the level- $k$  condition forces  $k$  to be the unique index of  $c$  exceeding  $k - 1$  that is admissible at level  $k$ , but then  $c$  contains an index  $b > k$  as its cycle top, so  $c$  contains two indices  $\geq k$ , violating the level- $(k - 1)$  condition. Hence  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ .  $\square$

The heart of the induction is the following cancellation, which replaces the informal “the sums are empty” step of the classical argument. When  $u(k) = w(k)$  the diagonal term alone already reproduces  $c_k(u, w)$ , by adjoining the variable  $y_{u(k)}$  to the product  $\mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_{k-1}}; z)$ ; the reflection sums and the quantum term must therefore cancel among themselves.

**Lemma 5.10** (Reflection-drop cancellation). *Suppose  $u, w \in S_\infty$ , let  $k > 1$ , and suppose  $u(k) = w(k)$ . Then*

$$\sum_{a < k, wt_{ak} \triangleleft w} \text{sign}(a - k) \kappa_{ak} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{ak}) + \sum_{b > k, wt_{kb} \triangleleft w} \text{sign}(b - k) \kappa_{kb} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{kb}) + q_{k-1} c_{k-2}(u, w) = 0,$$

where  $\kappa_{rs} = q_{rs}$  if  $wt_{rs} \triangleleft w$  is length-decreasing and  $\kappa_{rs} = 1$  if it is length-increasing. In fact the two reflection sums contribute at most one nonzero summand in total: it occurs precisely when  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  (equivalently, when the quantum term is nonzero), it is indexed by some  $a < k$ , and it equals  $-q_{k-1} c_{k-2}(u, w)$ .

*Proof.* Throughout we use that  $u(k) = w(k)$ , so that  $k$  is a fixed point of  $\pi := u^{-1}w$ .

*Step 1: no reflection  $t_{kb}$  with  $b > k$  contributes.* Suppose  $b > k$  and  $wt_{kb} \triangleleft w$  with  $c_{k-1}(u, wt_{kb}) \neq 0$ , so  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} v$  for  $v := wt_{kb}$ . Then  $u^{-1}v = \pi t_{kb}$ ; since  $k$  is a fixed point of  $\pi$  and  $b > k$ , right multiplication by  $t_{kb}$  adjoins  $k$  to the  $\pi$ -cycle containing  $b$  (or creates the 2-cycle  $(kb)$ ). Either way the resulting cycle of  $u^{-1}v$  contains two indices exceeding  $k - 1$ , namely  $k$  and an index  $\geq b > k$ , contradicting the level- $(k - 1)$  condition of Lemma 5.3. Hence only reflections  $t_{ak}$  with  $a < k$  can contribute, and each such summand carries the sign  $\text{sign}(a - k) = -1$ .

*Step 2: the reflection sum has at most one nonzero term, occurring precisely when  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ .* A reflection  $t_{ak}$  with  $a < k$  contributes precisely when  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} v$  for  $v := wt_{ak}$ ; here  $u^{-1}v = \pi t_{ak}$ , so  $t_{ak}$  adjoins the fixed point  $k$  to the  $\pi$ -cycle containing  $a$  (or creates the 2-cycle  $(ak)$  when  $a$  is fixed by  $\pi$ ). By Lemma 5.3,  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} v$  requires this enlarged cycle to contain exactly one index exceeding  $k - 1$ ; as it already contains  $k$ , it may contain no further index  $\geq k$ . Since  $k$  is fixed by  $\pi$ , an index occurring in a nontrivial  $\pi$ -cycle and

exceeding  $k - 1$  is in fact  $\geq k + 1$ , unless it equals  $k - 1$ . Thus the enlarged cycle is admissible only if the  $\pi$ -cycle receiving  $k$  has all indices  $\leq k - 1$ , i.e. its top equals  $k - 1$ ; the  $\pi$ -cycles being disjoint, at most one  $a < k$  contributes. Such a configuration exists exactly when  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ : if  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  and  $k - 1$  is not fixed by  $\pi$ , then the  $\pi$ -cycle through  $k - 1$  has top  $k - 1$  (any second index  $\geq k - 1$  would be  $\geq k + 1$ , violating the level- $(k - 2)$  condition), while if  $k - 1$  is fixed the choice  $a = k - 1$  creates the 2-cycle  $(k - 1 k)$ ; conversely a contributing  $t_{ak}$  forces a  $\pi$ -cycle of top  $k - 1$  (or  $k - 1$  fixed with  $a = k - 1$ ), whence  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ . This is exactly the condition under which the quantum term is nonzero.

*Step 3: the contributing term cancels the quantum term.* Assume  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , let  $t_{a^*k}$  ( $a^* < k$ ) be the unique contributing reflection, and set  $v := wt_{a^*k}$ . By Step 2 the cycle of  $u^{-1}v$  containing  $k$  has top  $k$ . Since  $v$  agrees with  $w$  off  $\{a^*, k\}$  and  $v(a^*) = w(k) = u(k)$ , both  $a^*$  and  $k - 1$  leave the agreement set in passing to level  $k - 1$ , and comparison of the invariants of Definition 2.9 gives

$$\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, v) = \text{fix}_{k-2}(u, w), \quad n_{k-1}(u, v) = n_{k-2}(u, w) + 1$$

(using  $n_m = m - |\text{fix}_m|$ ). Hence  $c_{k-1}(u, v)$  and  $c_{k-2}(u, w)$  carry the *same* factorial elementary polynomial  $\mathbf{E}(y_P; z)$  with  $P = \text{fix}_{k-2}(u, w)$ . Finally the  $q$ -weights match. Write  $\kappa_{a^*k} = 1$  if  $t_{a^*k}$  is length-increasing and  $\kappa_{a^*k} = q_{a^*k}$  if length-decreasing. As the  $q$ -weight is multiplicative over the cycles of  $u^{-1}(\cdot)$  and only the cycle receiving  $k$  is altered (from top  $k - 1$  to top  $k$ ), the definition of the weights yields

$$\kappa_{a^*k} q_{k-1}(u, v) = q_{k-1} q_{k-2}(u, w).$$

Therefore the contributing summand is

$$\text{sign}(a^* - k) \kappa_{a^*k} c_{k-1}(u, v) = -\kappa_{a^*k} q_{k-1}(u, v) \mathbf{E}(y_P; z) = -q_{k-1} q_{k-2}(u, w) \mathbf{E}(y_P; z) = -q_{k-1} c_{k-2}(u, w),$$

cancelling the quantum term. When  $u \not\overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  the quantum term vanishes and, by Step 2, no reflection contributes; all three terms are 0. In every case the displayed sum is 0.  $\square$

*Remark 5.11.* The content of Lemma 5.10 is the identification of the quantum term  $q_{k-1}c_{k-2}(u, w)$  with the unique level- $(k - 1)$  neighbor  $v$  satisfying  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} v$ ,  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} v$ ,  $\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, v) = \text{fix}_{k-2}(u, w)$  and  $n_{k-1}(u, v) = n_{k-2}(u, w) + 1$ , obtained by adjoining the fixed point  $k$  to the  $\pi$ -cycle of top  $k - 1$ . The connecting reflection  $t_{a^*k}$  may be length-increasing or length-decreasing; in either case its weight  $\kappa_{a^*k}$  satisfies the balance  $\kappa_{a^*k} q_{k-1}(u, v) = q_{k-1} q_{k-2}(u, w)$ . Uniqueness of  $v$  is a consequence of the cycle structure (there is a single  $\pi$ -cycle of top  $k - 1$ ); this intrinsic matching by the invariants  $(P, n)$  is what the  $u(k) \neq w(k)$  branch of Lemma 5.13 invokes.

When  $u(k) \neq w(k)$  the position  $k$  lies in a nontrivial cycle of  $\pi = u^{-1}w$ , and the reflection sums of the vanishing identity below no longer telescope against the diagonal; instead they cancel among themselves and against the quantum term, one  $q$ -weight at a time. The following lemma isolates this cancellation. It is the moved-case counterpart of Lemma 5.10, and its non-quantum instances ( $M = 1$ ) reduce to the pairing of an up-neighbor against a down-neighbor effected by [8, Lemma 7.9] in the cancellation of the classical Pieri rule [8, Proof of Proposition 4.4].

**Lemma 5.12** (Moved reflection cancellation). *Let  $u, w \in S_\infty$ , let  $k > 1$ , and suppose  $u \not\overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  with  $u(k) \neq w(k)$ . Let  $\pi = u^{-1}w$ , let  $C$  be the  $\pi$ -cycle containing  $k$  — nontrivial, since  $u(k) \neq w(k)$  — and set  $B = \max(C)$ . Fix a  $q$ -monomial  $q^M \neq q_{k-1}(u, w)$ , and let  $\mathcal{G}_M$  be the set of Monk summands of (5.3)–(5.4) of  $q$ -weight  $q^M$ , augmented by the quantum term  $q_{k-1}c_{k-2}(u, w)$  of (5.5) when  $q^M = q_{k-1}q_{k-2}(u, w)$ . Then the summands of  $\mathcal{G}_M$  sum to 0.*

*Proof.* A neighbor  $v = wt$ , with  $t \in \{t_{ak} : a < k\} \cup \{t_{kb} : b > k\}$ , contributes to  $\mathcal{G}_M$  only if  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} v$ ; writing  $\sigma = u^{-1}v = \pi t$ , Lemma 5.3 requires every cycle of  $\sigma$  to contain exactly one index exceeding  $k - 1$ . Since  $t$  moves  $\pi$  only at its two positions, one of which is  $k \in C$ , the passage  $\pi \rightsquigarrow \sigma$  either *splits*  $C$  (when the other position lies in  $C$ ) or *merges*  $C$  with the component of the other position (when it does not); every other  $\pi$ -cycle is unchanged and so must already satisfy the level- $(k - 1)$  condition.

*Up-neighbors are unique and force  $C$  to have exactly the indices  $k, B$  above  $k - 1$ .* Let  $v = wt_{kb}$  with  $b > k$ . If  $b \notin C$ , the merge produces a cycle containing  $k, b$  and  $B \geq b$ , hence two indices exceeding  $k - 1$ : inadmissible. Thus  $b \in C$ , and  $t_{kb}$  splits  $C$  into a piece through  $k$  and a piece through  $b$ ; admissibility forces each to hold a single index above  $k - 1$ , so  $b$  is that index for its piece. As  $B = \max(C) > k - 1$ , this

yields  $b = B$  and shows  $C$  has exactly the two indices  $k, B$  above  $k - 1$ , with  $B > k$ . Hence a contributing up-neighbor, if present, is unique and equals  $wt_{kB}$ .

*Down-neighbors.* Let  $v = wt_{ak}$  with  $a < k$ . If  $a \in C$  (a *split*), admissibility assigns the indices of  $C$  above  $k - 1$  one to each nontrivial piece: if  $C$  has three or more such indices no split is admissible; if it has exactly two,  $k$  and  $B > k$ , the split separates them (and then  $wt_{kB}$  is the up-neighbor); if it has only  $k$ , so  $B = k$ , the split peels a fixed point off  $C$ . If  $a \notin C$  (a *merge*), then  $C \cup (\text{component of } a)$  must retain a single index above  $k - 1$ , namely  $k$ , forcing  $B = k$  and the component of  $a$  to have all indices  $\leq k - 1$ . We record the resulting  $q$ -weights.

(1) *The case  $B = k$ .* Either  $a$  is adjoined as a fixed point — then  $v(a) = w(k) = u(a)$  reinstates below  $k$  the agreement lost at  $k$ , the cycle tops are unchanged, and the summand carries weight  $q_{k-1}(u, w)$  — or the component absorbed into  $C$  is a nontrivial cycle, whose unique index above  $k - 2$  is then  $k - 1$  (being  $\leq k - 1$  and  $> k - 2$ ); the merged cycle acquires the extra factor  $q_{k-1}$ , and a direct comparison of the invariants of Definition 2.9 gives

$$\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, v) = \text{fix}_{k-2}(u, w), \quad n_{k-1}(u, v) = n_{k-2}(u, w) + 1, \quad \kappa_{ak}q_{k-1}(u, v) = q_{k-1}q_{k-2}(u, w),$$

the very identities of Lemma 5.10, with the  $\pi$ -cycle of top  $k - 1$  now attached to  $C$  in place of the fixed point  $k$ ; the computation is otherwise verbatim, and by uniqueness of the  $\pi$ -cycle of top  $k - 1$  there is at most one such  $v$ .

(2) *The case  $B > k$ .* Here only the split with  $C = \{k, B\}$  above  $k - 1$  occurs, and it separates  $k$  from  $B$ .

*Cancellation.* Suppose first  $q^M = q_{k-1}q_{k-2}(u, w)$ , so the quantum term lies in  $\mathcal{G}_M$  and  $u \overset{k-2}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ ; then every  $\pi$ -cycle has exactly one index above  $k - 2$ , in particular  $B = k$ , and by the up-paragraph  $\mathcal{G}_M$  contains no up-neighbor. By (1) the summands of weight  $q^M$  reduce to the single merge down-neighbor  $v$  with  $\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, v) = \text{fix}_{k-2}(u, w)$ ; then  $c_{k-1}(u, v)$  and  $c_{k-2}(u, w)$  carry the same factorial elementary polynomial  $\mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_{k-2}(u, w)}; z)$ , and the down summand, of sign  $\text{sign}(a - k) = -1$ , equals  $-q_{k-1}c_{k-2}(u, w)$  and cancels the quantum term. (If no such  $v$  exists the quantum term already vanishes.)

Now suppose  $q^M \neq q_{k-1}(u, w), q_{k-1}q_{k-2}(u, w)$ . By (1) every merge or peel down carries weight  $q_{k-1}(u, w)$  or  $q_{k-1}q_{k-2}(u, w)$ , hence lies outside  $\mathcal{G}_M$ ; so every summand of  $\mathcal{G}_M$  is of split type with  $C = \{k, B\}$ ,  $B > k$  (whence also  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ ). For each such summand  $\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, v) = \text{fix}_{k-1}(u, w)$ : the up  $wt_{kB}$  agrees with  $w$  below  $k$ , while a split down  $wt_{ak}$  agrees with  $w$  below  $k$  except at  $a \in C$ , where it takes the value  $w(k)$ ; but  $a$  is not fixed by  $\pi$ , and  $u(a) \neq w(k)$  (otherwise, by (1), the summand would have weight  $q_{k-1}(u, w)$ ), so no agreement below  $k$  is created or destroyed. Consequently all summands of  $\mathcal{G}_M$  share the factorial elementary factor  $E_0 = \mathbf{E}(y_P; z)$ , where  $P = \text{fix}_{k-1}(u, w)$ . Finally, when  $C = \{k, B\}$  there are exactly two admissible neighbors through position  $k$ : the up  $wt_{kB}$ , and — since  $C$  has a single descent (Lemma 5.5) and, as in the proof of Lemma 5.8, exactly one covering split of  $C$  separates  $k$  from  $B$  — a single down  $wt_{a^*k}$ . The two reflections differ by the 3-cycle  $(a^*, B, k)$ ; each resolves the cycle  $C$  into two cycles of tops  $k$  and  $B$  while leaving the other cycles untouched, so by the multiplicativity of the  $q$ -weight (Definition 2.9) and Lemma 5.7, which fixes  $\text{desc}_u(C)$  and hence the drop factors, both  $\kappa_{kB}q_{k-1}(u, wt_{kB})$  and  $\kappa_{a^*k}q_{k-1}(u, wt_{a^*k})$  equal the weight  $q^M$  of  $\mathcal{G}_M$ . With opposite signs  $\text{sign}(B - k) = +1$  and  $\text{sign}(a^* - k) = -1$  and common coefficient  $E_0$ , the up and the down cancel. Hence  $\mathcal{G}_M = 0$ .  $\square$

The remaining case of the induction is when  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , where the target coefficient is 0.

**Lemma 5.13** (Vanishing). *Suppose  $u, w \in S_\infty$ , let  $k > 1$ , and suppose  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ . Then*

$$\begin{aligned} (y_{w(k)} - z_1) c_{k-1}(u, w) + \sum_{b > k, wt_{kb} \triangleleft w} \kappa_{kb} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{kb}) - \sum_{a < k, wt_{ak} \triangleleft w} \kappa_{ak} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{ak}) \\ + q_{k-1} c_{k-2}(u, w) = 0, \end{aligned}$$

where  $\kappa_{rs} = q_{rs}$  if  $wt_{rs} \triangleleft w$  is length-decreasing and  $\kappa_{rs} = 1$  if it is length-increasing.

*Proof.* Suppose first that  $u(k) = w(k)$ . Then by Lemma 5.9(i) also  $u \overset{k-1}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , so  $c_{k-1}(u, w)$  vanishes; hence the diagonal term is 0, and the remaining reflection sums and the quantum term cancel by Lemma 5.10. This settles the case  $u(k) = w(k)$  completely.

Now suppose  $u(k) \neq w(k)$ . Since  $u \overset{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$ , Lemma 5.3 shows the cycle of  $u^{-1}w$  containing  $k$  has a top  $b > k$ , so  $c_k(u, w) = 0$ ; writing  $F$  for the right-hand side (5.2)–(5.5), we must show  $F = 0$ .

We grade by the cohomological degree  $\deg q_i = 2$ . Under this grading (5.1) is homogeneous, and the  $q_i$  are algebraically independent over  $\mathbb{Z}[y, z]$ . By the definition of  $c_m$ , each summand of  $F$  is a monomial in the  $q_i$  times a factorial elementary polynomial in  $\mathbb{Z}[y, z]$ ; collecting by  $q$ -monomial we write  $F = \sum_M q^M F_M$  with  $F_M \in \mathbb{Z}[y, z]$ , and

$$F = 0 \iff F_M = 0 \text{ for every } q\text{-monomial } M.$$

Fix  $M$  and let  $\mathcal{G}_M$  be the collection of summands of  $F$  whose  $q$ -weight equals  $q^M$ ; here the diagonal (5.2) carries weight  $q_{k-1}(u, w)$ , the quantum term carries  $q_{k-1}q_{k-2}(u, w)$ , and the Monk summand of (5.3)–(5.4) reaching  $w' = wt_{ak}$  or  $w' = wt_{kb}$  carries  $\kappa q_{k-1}(u, w')$  with  $\kappa \in \{1, q_{ak}, q_{kb}\}$  its drop-weight. We show  $F_M = 0$  in two exhaustive cases.

*Case (i):  $\mathcal{G}_M$  contains the diagonal.* It carries weight  $q_{k-1}(u, w)$ , so  $q^M = q_{k-1}(u, w)$ ; in particular  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} w$ . Write  $P = \text{fix}_{k-1}(u, w)$  and  $n = n_{k-1}(u, w)$ . Set  $a_0 = u^{-1}(w(k))$ ; since  $u(k) \neq w(k)$  and  $w(k)$  is a value of  $u$  occurring at a position  $< k$  (this holds whenever the diagonal is nonzero), we have  $a_0 < k$ . The Monk summand indexed by  $t_{a_0k}$  then satisfies  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} wt_{a_0k}$  with

$$\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, wt_{a_0k}) = P \cup \{w(k)\}, \quad n_{k-1}(u, wt_{a_0k}) = n - 1,$$

carries weight  $q_{k-1}(u, w)$ , and is the *only* Monk summand in  $\mathcal{G}_M$ . Dividing  $\mathcal{G}_M$  by the common factor  $q_{k-1}(u, w)$ , its two contributions read

$$(y_{w(k)} - z_1) \mathbf{E}(y_P; z) - \mathbf{E}(y_{P \cup \{w(k)\}}; z),$$

which vanish since  $\mathbf{E}(y_{P \cup \{w(k)\}}; z) = (y_{w(k)} - z_1) \mathbf{E}(y_P; z)$  by adjoining the variable  $y_{w(k)}$ . Hence  $F_M = 0$ .

*Case (ii):  $\mathcal{G}_M$  does not contain the diagonal.* Then  $q^M \neq q_{k-1}(u, w)$ , and  $\mathcal{G}_M$  consists of Monk summands of (5.3)–(5.4) together with the quantum term when  $q^M = q_{k-1}q_{k-2}(u, w)$ . By Lemma 5.12 these summands sum to 0, so  $F_M = 0$ .

As the two cases are exhaustive, every  $F_M = 0$ , so  $F = 0$ .  $\square$

We now record the recurrence satisfied by the quantum factorial elementary polynomials, which drives the induction.

**Lemma 5.14.** *For all integers  $k$  we have*

$$\tilde{E}_{k,k}(x; z) = (x_k - z_1) \tilde{E}_{k-1,k-1}(x; z) + q_{k-1} \tilde{E}_{k-2,k-2}(x; z),$$

with the conventions  $\tilde{E}_{0,0}^q = 1$  and  $\tilde{E}_{k,k} = 0$  if  $k < 0$ . Moreover, the ordinary polynomials  $\mathbf{E}(y_A; z) = \prod_{i \in A} (y_i - z_1)$  satisfy, for any set  $A$  and any  $c \notin A$ , the single-variable identity

$$\mathbf{E}(y_{A \cup \{c\}}; z) = (y_c - z_1) \mathbf{E}(y_A; z).$$

The first recurrence is the quantization of the classical relation  $E_{k,k} = (x_k - z_1)E_{k-1,k-1}$ ; the extra term  $q_{k-1} \tilde{E}_{k-2,k-2}$  is the only feature absent from the non-quantum setting. Discarding all quantum terms recovers the classical Pieri formula [8, Theorem 7.1], whose term-by-term cancellation is carried out in [8, Proof of Proposition 4.4] by means of the reflection-matching Lemmas 7.6–7.9 of that paper; we adapt that argument, the essential new points being the length-decreasing steps permitted by Lemma 5.3 and the attendant bookkeeping of the powers of  $q$ .

*Proof of Theorem 2.11.* For a permutation  $w$ , write  $[\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w]F$  for the coefficient of  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x; y)$  in an expansion  $F$  of a quantum double Schubert polynomial in the basis  $\{\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x; y)\}$ . With this notation the theorem is the assertion that, for all  $u$  and all  $k \geq 1$ ,

$$[\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w](\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) \tilde{E}_{k,k}(x; z)) = \begin{cases} q_k(u, w) \mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_k(u, w)}; z) & \text{if } u \xrightarrow{k} w, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

For brevity, when  $u \xrightarrow{m} w$  we set

$$c_m(u, w) = q_m(u, w) \mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_m(u, w)}; z),$$

and  $c_m(u, w) = 0$  if  $u \not\xrightarrow{m} w$ . The claim is that  $[\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w](\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u \tilde{E}_{k,k}) = c_k(u, w)$ .

We argue by strong induction on  $k$ .

*Base case*  $k = 1$ . We have  $\tilde{E}_{1,1}(x; z) = x_1 - z_1$ , and Lemma 5.1 with  $i = j = 1$  gives

$$(x_1 - z_1) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) = (y_{u(1)} - z_1) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) + \sum_{\substack{b > 1 \\ \ell(ut_{1b}) = \ell(u) + 1}} \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{ut_{1b}}(x; y) + \sum_{\substack{b > 1 \\ \ell(ut_{1b}) = \ell(u) - 2(b-1) + 1}} q_{1b} \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{ut_{1b}}(x; y).$$

The permutations  $w$  with  $u \xrightarrow{1} w$  are exactly  $w = u$  and  $w = ut_{1b}$  for  $b > 1$  with  $u \triangleleft ut_{1b}$ , since Definition 2.9 permits at most one reflection when  $k = 1$ . For  $w = u$  we have  $q_1 = 1$ ,  $\text{fix}_1(u, u) = \{u(1)\}$ , and  $\mathbf{E}(y_{\{u(1)\}}; z) = y_{u(1)} - z_1$ , matching the diagonal term. For  $w = ut_{1b}$  we have  $\text{fix}_1 = \emptyset$  and  $\mathbf{E}(y_\emptyset; z) = 1$ ; if the step is length-increasing then  $q_1(u, w) = 1$ , matching the second sum, and if it is length-decreasing then  $q_1(u, w) = q_{1b}$ , matching the third sum. All other coefficients vanish on both sides. This proves the base case.

*Inductive step.* Fix  $k > 1$  and assume the claim at all levels  $m < k$ . By Lemma 5.14,

$$(5.1) \quad \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u \tilde{E}_{k,k} = (x_k - z_1) (\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u \tilde{E}_{k-1,k-1}) + q_{k-1} \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u \tilde{E}_{k-2,k-2}.$$

By the inductive hypothesis,  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u \tilde{E}_{k-1,k-1} = \sum_v c_{k-1}(u, v) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v$ . Applying Lemma 5.1 with  $i = k$ ,  $j = 1$  to each  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_v$  and extracting the coefficient of  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w$  from (5.1), we obtain

$$(5.2) \quad [\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w] (\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u \tilde{E}_{k,k}) = (y_{w(k)} - z_1) c_{k-1}(u, w)$$

$$(5.3) \quad + \sum_{\substack{b > k, wt_{kb} \triangleleft w \\ \ell(w) = \ell(wt_{kb}) + 1}} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{kb}) + \sum_{\substack{b > k, wt_{kb} \triangleleft w \\ \ell(w) = \ell(wt_{kb}) - 2(b-k) + 1}} q_{kb} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{kb})$$

$$(5.4) \quad - \sum_{\substack{a < k, wt_{ak} \triangleleft w \\ \ell(w) = \ell(wt_{ak}) + 1}} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{ak}) - \sum_{\substack{a < k, wt_{ak} \triangleleft w \\ \ell(w) = \ell(wt_{ak}) - 2(k-a) + 1}} q_{ak} c_{k-1}(u, wt_{ak})$$

$$(5.5) \quad + q_{k-1} c_{k-2}(u, w),$$

where we used that  $\text{sign}(b - k) = 1$  for  $b > k$  and  $\text{sign}(a - k) = -1$  for  $a < k$ , and that a summand in (5.3)–(5.4) is present precisely when  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} wt_{kb}$ , respectively  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} wt_{ak}$  (otherwise  $c_{k-1} = 0$ ). We must show this equals  $c_k(u, w)$ . We distinguish three cases according to whether  $u(k) = w(k)$  and, when  $u(k) \neq w(k)$ , whether  $u \xrightarrow{k} w$ ; by Lemma 5.9 these cases are exhaustive and, in particular, the combination  $u(k) \neq w(k)$  with both  $u \xrightarrow{k} w$  and  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} w$  never occurs.

*Case 1:*  $u(k) = w(k)$ . By Lemma 5.9(i) we have  $u \xrightarrow{k} w$  if and only if  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} w$ ; suppose first that both hold. Since  $u(k) = w(k)$ ,

$$\text{fix}_k(u, w) = \text{fix}_{k-1}(u, w) \cup \{u(k)\}, \quad q_k(u, w) = q_{k-1}(u, w),$$

the second equality holding because no reflection with first index  $k$  occurs. The diagonal contribution (5.2) then gives

$$(y_{u(k)} - z_1) c_{k-1}(u, w) = q_{k-1}(u, w) (y_{u(k)} - z_1) \mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, w)}; z) = q_k(u, w) \mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_k(u, w)}; z) = c_k(u, w),$$

by adjoining the variable  $y_{u(k)}$  as in Lemma 5.14. The remaining contributions are the reflection sums (5.3), (5.4) and the quantum term  $q_{k-1} c_{k-2}(u, w)$  of (5.5), which sum to 0 by Lemma 5.10. Hence the total is  $c_k(u, w)$ , as required. If instead  $u(k) = w(k)$  but  $u \not\xrightarrow{k} w$  (equivalently  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} w$ ), then  $c_k(u, w) = 0$  and the diagonal term vanishes, while the reflection sums and quantum term again cancel by Lemma 5.10; the total is  $0 = c_k(u, w)$ .

*Case 2:*  $u \xrightarrow{k} w$  but  $u \not\xrightarrow{k-1} w$ . By Lemma 5.8 there is a unique  $b > k$  with  $wt_{kb} \triangleleft w$  and  $u \xrightarrow{k-1} wt_{kb}$ ; set  $v = wt_{kb}$ . This is exactly the unique nonvanishing summand of (5.3), and by Lemma 5.8 the sums (5.4) vanish, as does the diagonal (5.2) and the quantum term (5.5) (since  $u \not\xrightarrow{k-1} w$  and  $u \xrightarrow{k-2} w$ ). Moreover  $\text{fix}_k(u, w) = \text{fix}_{k-1}(u, v)$ , so

$$\mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_k(u, w)}; z) = \mathbf{E}(y_{\text{fix}_{k-1}(u, v)}; z).$$

If  $\ell(w) = \ell(v) + 1$  then the reflection  $t_{kb}$  is length-increasing, so by Definition 2.9  $q_k(u, w) = q_{k-1}(u, v)$  and the contribution is  $c_{k-1}(u, v) = c_k(u, w)$ . If instead  $\ell(w) = \ell(v) - 2(b - k) + 1$  then  $t_{kb}$  is length-decreasing, Definition 2.9 gives  $q_k(u, w) = q_{k-1}(u, v) q_{kb}$ , and the contribution is  $q_{kb} c_{k-1}(u, v) = c_k(u, w)$ . In both cases

the coefficient equals  $c_k(u, w)$ , as required. This is the step at which the quantum drop terms of Lemma 5.1 and the recursive definition of  $q_k(u, w)$  interlock.

*Case 3:*  $u \not\stackrel{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  (with  $u(k) \neq w(k)$ ). Here  $c_k(u, w) = 0$ , so we must show the coefficient (5.2)–(5.5) vanishes. This is exactly the assertion of Lemma 5.13. (The subcase  $u(k) = w(k)$  with  $u \not\stackrel{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  was already treated at the end of Case 1.)

In all cases  $[\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w](\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u \tilde{E}_{k,k}) = c_k(u, w)$ , completing the induction and the proof.  $\square$

## 6. ADDITIONAL FORMULAS

**Definition 6.1.** Consider a permutation  $d_2[k]$  satisfying

$$\mathfrak{c}(d_2[k]) = \overbrace{(2, 2, \dots, 2)}^{k \text{ times}}.$$

The double Schubert polynomial  $\mathfrak{S}_{d_2[k]}(x; y)$  is a product of two factorial elementary symmetric polynomials, specifically:

$$\mathfrak{S}_{d_2[k]}(x; y) = E_k(x; y_1) E_k(x; y_2).$$

Therefore, the Pieri formula in [8] easily transfers to being able to multiply by  $\mathfrak{S}_{d_2[k]}(x; y)$ .

For quantum double Schubert polynomials,  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{d_2[k]}(x; y)$  is *not* a product of factorial quantum elementary polynomials. For example:

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{d_2[1]}(x; y) = \tilde{E}_{1,2}(x; y) \tilde{E}_{1,1}(x; y) - E_{2,2}^q(x; y)$$

$$\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_{d_2[2]}(x; y) = E_{2,3}^q(x; y) E_{2,2}^q(x; y) - E_{3,3}^q(x; y) E_{1,2}^q(x; y)$$

For abbreviation purposes, we denote this polynomial by  $D_k^q(x; y)$ .

We define a relation  $\stackrel{k}{\Rightarrow}$  on permutations as follows. We say that  $u \stackrel{k}{\Rightarrow} w$  if and only if there exists a  $v \in S_\infty$  such that  $u \stackrel{k}{\rightsquigarrow} v$  and  $v \stackrel{k}{\rightsquigarrow} w$  satisfying the additional condition that if  $u^{-1}v$  is a product of disjoint cycles  $c_1, \dots, c_m$  and  $v^{-1}w$  is a product of disjoint cycles  $d_1, \dots, d_n$ , then for each  $d_i$  there exists a  $c_j$  such that  $d_i \cap c_j = \{\max(d_i)\} = \{\max(c_j)\}$ . Call the set of all such  $v$   $\text{pivot}_k(u, w)$ .

Then

**Theorem 6.2.** *We have that the product  $\tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_u(x; y) D_k^q(x; z)$  is equal to*

$$\sum_{\substack{k \\ u \Rightarrow w}} \sum_{v \in \text{pivot}_k(u, w)} q_k(u, v) q_k(v, w) E_{k-n_k(u, v)}(y_{\text{fix}_k(u, v)}; z_1) E_{k-n_k(v, w)}(y_{\text{fix}_k(v, w)}; z_2) \tilde{\mathfrak{S}}_w(x; y).$$

## 7. PETERSON-WOODWARD COMPARISON FORMULA

**Proposition 7.1** ([4, Proposition 2.10]). *Let  $W_P$  be a parabolic subgroup of  $W$ . Then for any  $\lambda_P \in Q^\vee / Q_P^\vee$ , we have that*

$$c_{u,v}^{w, \lambda_P}(y; y) = c_{u,v}^{w \omega_P \omega_{P'}, \lambda_B}(y; y),$$

where  $\omega_P$  is the longest element in  $W_P$ ,  $\omega_{P'}$  is the longest element in  $W_{P'}$ , where  $P'$  is the parabolic subgroup generated by  $\{s_\alpha \mid \alpha \in \Delta_P, \langle \alpha, \lambda_B \rangle = 0\}$ , and  $\lambda_B$  is the Peterson-Woodward lift of  $\lambda_P$ .

**Corollary 7.2.** *The Peterson-Woodward comparison formula holds for  $c_{u,v}^w(y; z)$ .*

*Proof.* We have that

$$c_{u,v}^{w, \lambda_P}(y; z) = \sum_{v_1 \cdot v_2 = v} c_{u,v_2}^{w, \lambda_P}(y; y) \mathfrak{S}_{v_1}(y; z)$$

By definition of a parabolic subgroup,  $v_2 \in W_P$  as well. Thus, this is equal to

$$\sum_{v_1 \cdot v_2 = v} c_{u,v_2}^{w \omega_P \omega_{P'}, \lambda_B}(y; y) \mathfrak{S}_{v_1}(y; z) = c_{u,v}^{w \omega_P \omega_{P'}, \lambda_B}(y; z).$$

$\square$



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